UOE-P4 · USE OF ENGLISH · PART 4

Key word transformations

Teoría: lo que el C2 añade sobre el C1

v1 · octubre de 2026 · 6 ítems · hasta 2 puntos por ítem · 3–8 palabras

Este documento da por sabido lo que ya funciona en el C1 Advanced y se centra en lo que el C2 exige de más: respuestas más largas, dos cambios por ítem y mucho más léxico fijo. Las secciones 1 y 2 explican la tarea y el método; la 3, la 4 y la 5, el contenido que se evalúa; la 6 recoge los errores que cuestan puntos y la 7 es una tabla de repaso por palabra clave. El asterisco (*) marca formas incorrectas.

1 Formato y puntuación

Cada ítem consta de una frase completa, una palabra clave en mayúsculas y una segunda frase con un hueco. Hay que completar el hueco para que la segunda frase signifique lo mismo que la primera. Son seis ítems y cada uno vale hasta 2 puntos: la parte aporta 12 de las 36 marcas de Use of English, un tercio de esa nota con solo seis frases.

> EJEMPLO · ASÍ SE PRESENTA UN ÍTEM
>
> People believe that the painting was stolen by a former employee.
>
> **HAVE**
>
> The painting _____ by a former employee.
>
> **Respuesta: IS BELIEVED TO HAVE BEEN STOLEN** (6 palabras)
>
> **Qué se puntúa:** is believed (pasiva impersonal) y to have been stolen (infinitivo perfecto pasivo).

Las reglas

- **Entre 3 y 8 palabras**, contando la palabra clave. Las contracciones cuentan como dos: didn't = did not. Cannot es una sola palabra. Fuera de ese margen la respuesta no puntúa.
- **La palabra clave no se toca**: no se puede cambiar de forma (CLOSE no puede pasar a closely ni a closed) ni omitir. Si cambia, el ítem vale 0.
- **Ortografía correcta.** Una palabra mal escrita cuesta el punto de la mitad en la que está.
- **Solo se escribe el contenido del hueco**, no la frase entera; en papel, en mayúsculas en la hoja de respuestas. Lo que hay antes y después del hueco no se puede modificar: la respuesta tiene que encajar con ello.
- **No hay una única respuesta.** Vale cualquier variante correcta que conserve el significado; la clave de corrección recoge las alternativas aceptadas.

Cómo se reparten los 2 puntos

Cada respuesta se divide en dos mitades de 1 punto que se corrigen por separado. En la práctica, cada mitad corresponde a uno de los dos cambios que exige el ítem. Consecuencia directa: un ítem resuelto a medias puede valer 1 punto, así que nunca se deja un hueco en blanco.

Qué cambia respecto al C1

El esqueleto de la tarea es el mismo; lo que cambia es la distancia entre las dos frases.

Aspecto	C1 Advanced	C2 Proficiency
Longitud	3–6 palabras	3–8 palabras: caben estructuras completas con dos cambios
Tipo de cambio	Normalmente uno, gramatical y bastante previsible	Casi siempre dos a la vez: uno gramatical y otro léxico
Léxico	Phrasal verbs y collocations frecuentes	Idioms, expresiones fijas, frases preposicionales y nominalización
Distancia entre frases	Se copia buena parte de la frase 1	Cambian el sujeto, la clase de palabra o la perspectiva: hay que reconstruir la frase

CLAVE

Ante cada ítem, la pregunta útil no es «¿qué estructura es?», sino «¿qué dos cosas cambian?». Cada cambio suele ser una mitad: si identificas los dos, tienes al menos un punto al alcance aunque uno de ellos falle.

2 Método en cuatro pasos

1. **Leer la palabra clave antes que nada** y preguntarse qué estructura o expresión exige. Una clave al principio del hueco suele marcar inversión o una cleft (SOONER, SUCH, ALL); un sustantivo inesperado suele ser un idiom (DARK, LOSS, STAKE); un sustantivo emparentado con un verbo de la frase 1 indica nominalización (DECISION, RESEMBLANCE).
2. **Comparar las dos frases**: qué se mantiene, qué cambia de sitio y qué falta. Fíjate sobre todo en lo que viene justo después del hueco: una preposición, un -ing, un that o un sustantivo condicionan la respuesta.
3. **Construir la respuesta** integrando la clave y enlazando con lo que hay antes y después del hueco. Ajusta tiempo verbal, sujeto y preposiciones dependientes.
4. **Comprobar**: mismo significado (nada añadido ni perdido: tiempo, negación, intensidad, quién hace qué), gramática que encaja con lo que sigue, entre 3 y 8 palabras, clave intacta y ortografía correcta.

Tres ejemplos resueltos

EJEMPLO 1 · INVERSIÓN + NOMINALIZACIÓN

The meeting was so chaotic that nothing was decided.

SUCH

_____ that nothing was decided.

Paso 1. SUCH abre la frase y después del hueco viene that: inversión enfática Such was + sustantivo + that.

Paso 2. Such was pide un sustantivo, pero la frase 1 da un adjetivo: chaotic → the chaos. Además, the meeting tiene que entrar en el hueco.

Paso 3. Such was the chaos at the meeting that nothing was decided.

Paso 4. Mismo significado, 7 palabras, clave intacta.

Respuesta: SUCH WAS THE CHAOS AT THE MEETING (7 palabras). También: **IN THE MEETING** o **DURING THE MEETING** en lugar de **AT THE MEETING**

Qué se puntúa: la inversión (such was) y la nominalización (the chaos at the meeting).

EJEMPLO 2 · MODAL PERFECTO + IDIOM

I'm sure the director didn't know anything about the cuts.

DARK

The director must _____ about the cuts.

Paso 1. DARK → idiom be in the dark (about sth): no saber nada de algo.

Paso 2. I'm sure + pasado equivale a must have + participio; must ya está fuera del hueco.

Paso 3. The director must have been in the dark about the cuts.

Paso 4. 5 palabras. Cuidado con have been kept in the dark: el idiom existe, pero añade que alguien se lo ocultó a propósito, algo que la frase 1 no dice. La respuesta segura no añade nada.

Respuesta: HAVE BEEN IN THE DARK (5 palabras)

Qué se puntúa: la deducción en pasado (have been) y el idiom (in the dark).

EJEMPLO 3 · CAMBIO DE SUJETO + PASIVA MODAL

It's possible that the fire was started deliberately.

RULED

The possibility that the fire was started deliberately _____.

Paso 1. RULED → phrasal verb rule sth out: descartar.

Paso 2. El sujeto pasa a ser the possibility, así que el hueco necesita el verbo. «Es posible» equivale a «no se puede descartar»: negación + modal + pasiva.

Paso 3. The possibility that the fire was started deliberately cannot be ruled out.

Paso 4. 4 palabras (cannot cuenta como una; con can't serían 5, también válido).

Respuesta: CANNOT BE RULED OUT (4 palabras)

Qué se puntúa: la pasiva modal negativa (cannot be) y el phrasal verb (ruled out).

3 Gramática de alto rendimiento

Lo que ya funciona en el C1 (pasiva básica, condicionales con if, estilo indirecto) se da por sabido. Aquí están las estructuras que más aparecen en el C2, en su versión más exigente. Cada apartado termina con un ítem modelo.

3.1 · Inversión tras adverbiales negativos y restrictivos

Cuando un adverbial negativo o restrictivo abre la frase, sujeto y auxiliar se invierten como en una pregunta. En las transformaciones, la clave suele ser el propio adverbial (SOONER, ONLY, LITTLE, TIME) o el auxiliar (HAD, DID).

Adverbial	Ejemplo
Never / Rarely / Seldom (before)	Seldom have I seen such dedication.
Hardly / Scarcely … when No sooner … than	Hardly had we sat down when the phone rang. No sooner had she left than it began to pour.
Not until …	Not until the results were published did we realise the scale of the problem.
Only when / after / if / by / then	Only by cutting costs can the firm survive.
Under no circumstances / On no account / In no way	On no account should you sign the contract.

Adverbial	Ejemplo
At no time / At no point	At no point was the public informed.
Little	Little did they know what lay ahead.
Not only … but (also)	Not only did he lie, but he also tried to blame others.
So + adj. … that Such + be … that	So severe was the storm that the bridge collapsed. Such was the demand that tickets sold out in an hour.
Nowhere	Nowhere else is the problem so acute.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

Con not until y only when / after / if, la inversión va en la oración principal, no en la subordinada: Only when I got home did I notice, nunca *Only when did I get home I noticed. Y los correlativos no se mezclan: hardly … when, no sooner … than.

ÍTEM MODELO

The public was never in any danger.

TIME

At _____ in any danger.

Respuesta: NO TIME WAS THE PUBLIC (5 palabras)

Qué se puntúa: el adverbial (no time) y la inversión (was the public).

3.2 · Condicionales sin if

En el C2 la condición rara vez aparece con if: se invierte el auxiliar o se usa una expresión que lo sustituye.

Forma	Ejemplo	Equivale a / nota
Should + subject + verb	Should you need any help, call this number.	if you need; registro formal
Were + subject + to + verb	Were the council to raise taxes, there would be protests.	if the council raised
Had + subject + past participle	Had I known, I would have come earlier.	if I had known
But for + noun	But for your help, we would have failed.	solo con sustantivo
Had it not been for / Were it not for	Were it not for the subsidies, the farm would close.	pasado / presente
Otherwise / Or (else)	We left early; otherwise we would have missed the train.	if we hadn't left early
Provided (that) / As long as / On condition that	You can borrow the car provided you fill it up.	condición estricta
Supposing / Suppose	Supposing you lost your job, what would you do?	hipótesis
In the event of + noun	In the event of a fire, use the stairs.	if there is
Unless	We won't finish unless we start now.	if … not

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

En la inversión condicional negativa no hay contracción: Had it not been for…, Should you not wish to…; nunca *Hadn't it been for….

ÍTEM MODELO

If your sister hadn't intervened, the deal would have collapsed.

BUT

The deal would have collapsed _____ intervention.

Respuesta: BUT FOR YOUR SISTER'S (4 palabras)

Qué se puntúa: but for y el posesivo your sister's, que cuenta como una palabra.

3.3 · Pasiva impersonal y causativa

Con verbos de opinión y de información (say, believe, think, consider, know, report, expect, allege, rumour) el C2 prefiere la pasiva personal: la persona o cosa de la que se habla pasa a ser el sujeto y el tiempo de la acción se marca con el infinitivo.

Forma	Cuándo	Ejemplo
is said to + verb	Simultánea o habitual	She is said to live abroad.
is said to be + -ing	En curso	The minister is thought to be considering resigning.
is said to have + past participle	Anterior al verbo de opinión	He is known to have worked for the secret service.
is said to have been + past participle	Anterior y pasiva	The paintings are said to have been stolen to order.
there is / are said to be	Existencia	There are believed to be fewer than fifty left in the wild.
It is said that + clause	Forma de partida habitual en la frase 1	It was rumoured that she had resigned. → She was rumoured to have resigned.

Causativa: have / get sth done para encargar o sufrir algo (We had the roof repaired. / She had her bag stolen.) y have sb do / get sb to do. **Pasiva tras -ing e infinitivo:** She resents being told what to do. / He expects to be promoted.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

El tiempo de la acción se lleva al infinitivo; el verbo de opinión conserva el suyo: It was believed that he had fled → He was believed to have fled. Rumour como verbo va casi siempre en pasiva: It is rumoured that… / She is rumoured to…

ÍTEM MODELO

It is thought that the thieves escaped through a skylight.

HAVE

The thieves _____ through a skylight.

Respuesta: ARE THOUGHT TO HAVE ESCAPED (5 palabras)

Qué se puntúa: la pasiva personal (are thought) y el infinitivo perfecto (to have escaped).

3.4 · Cleft sentences y énfasis

Las cleft sentences parten la información en dos para resaltar una parte. Aparecen cuando la clave es WHAT, ALL, IT, THING, LAST o REASON.

Estructura	Ejemplo
It is / was + X + that / who …	It was the noise that kept me awake.
It was not until … that …	It was not until midnight that the results came in.
What + clause + be …	What annoyed me was his attitude.
What + subject + do + be + (to) infinitive	What you should do is (to) call him at once.
All (that) + subject + verb + be …	All I need is a bit more time.
The thing / reason / person / place + clause	The reason I left was the salary.
The last thing + subject + verb	The last thing I expected was an apology.
X + be + what … (orden invertido)	A long holiday is what we all need.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

Tras What … do o All … do va infinitivo, con o sin to: All you have to do is (to) sign here. Y no se añade un that: *What I need is that you listen → What I need is for you to listen.

ÍTEM MODELO

I only want you to tell me the truth.

ALL

_____ tell me the truth.

Respuesta: ALL I WANT IS FOR YOU TO (7 palabras). También: **ALL I WANT YOU TO DO IS** (7)

Qué se puntúa: la cleft con all (all I want is) y el enlace con el infinitivo (for you to).

3.5 · Modales perfectos y grados de certeza

La frase 1 suele expresar la certeza con palabras llanas (I'm sure, it's possible, it wasn't necessary) y la clave obliga a pasarla a un modal o a una expresión de probabilidad (WELL, BOUND, WAY, NEED).

Significado	Estructura	Ejemplo
Deducción sobre el pasado	must have / can't have / couldn't have + p.p.	She must have forgotten. / He can't have known.
Posibilidad pasada	may / might / could (well) have + p.p.	They could have taken a wrong turn.
Innecesario, pero se hizo	needn't have + p.p.	You needn't have brought anything.
Innecesario (sin decir si se hizo)	didn't need to / didn't have to + verb	I didn't need to queue: I had a ticket.
Obligación o expectativa incumplida	should have + p.p.; was supposed to	The parcel was supposed to arrive yesterday.
Plan que no se cumplió	was to have + p.p.	The bridge was to have opened in May.
Certeza sobre el futuro	be bound / sure / certain to	She's bound to find out.

Significado	Estructura	Ejemplo
Probabilidad	be (un)likely to; in all likelihood; there's every chance that	In all likelihood, the vote will be postponed.
Imposibilidad enfática	there's no way (that); there's no chance of + -ing	There's no way he'll agree.
Mejor opción a falta de otra	might as well + verb	We might as well walk; the bus isn't coming.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

Es la distinción favorita del C2: You needn't have cooked implica que cocinaste y no hacía falta; You didn't need to cook no dice si lo hiciste o no.

ÍTEM MODELO

It's quite possible that the letter got lost in the post.

WELL

The letter _____ in the post.

Respuesta: MAY WELL HAVE GOT LOST (5 palabras). También: **MIGHT WELL** o **COULD WELL** en lugar de **MAY WELL**; **HAVE BEEN LOST** en lugar de **HAVE GOT LOST**

Qué se puntúa: may well para «es muy posible» y el infinitivo perfecto (have got lost).

3.6 · Wish, would rather, it's high time, as if

Todas comparten la misma lógica: lo irreal o lo deseado retrocede un tiempo verbal.

Estructura	Uso	Ejemplo
wish / if only + past simple	Deseo sobre el presente	I wish I knew the answer.
wish / if only + past perfect	Lamento sobre el pasado	If only I hadn't said that.
wish + subject + would	Queja sobre lo que hace otro	I wish you would stop interrupting.
would rather / sooner + subject + past	Preferencia sobre lo que hace otro	I'd rather you didn't smoke in here.
would rather + subject + past perfect	Preferencia sobre el pasado	I'd rather you hadn't told her.
would rather + verb (than)	Preferencia propia	I'd rather stay in than go out tonight.
it's (high / about) time + subject + past	Algo que ya debería ocurrir	It's high time the council took action.
as if / as though + past	Comparación irreal	He talks as if he owned the place.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

Wish + would no se usa con el mismo sujeto (*I wish I would). Con would rather y otro sujeto nunca va presente: *I'd rather you don't.

ÍTEM MODELO

I'd prefer you not to mention this to anyone.

RATHER

I _____ this to anyone.

Respuesta: WOULD RATHER YOU DIDN'T MENTION (6 palabras)

Qué se puntúa: would rather you y el pasado didn't mention (didn't cuenta como dos palabras).

3.7 · Comparación y grado

Estructura	Significado	Ejemplo
nowhere near / not nearly as … as	Mucho menos	The sequel is nowhere near as good as the original.
every bit as … as	Igual de (enfático)	She is every bit as talented as her brother.
not so much X as Y	Más Y que X	It was not so much a holiday as an ordeal.
by far / easily + superlative	Con diferencia	It was by far the best performance of the night.
the + comparative …, the + comparative	Cuanto más…, más…	The longer you wait, the harder it gets.
couldn't + comparative	Máximo posible	I couldn't have been happier.
no + comparative	Negación del grado	The patient is no better today.
second to none	El mejor	Their customer service is second to none.
far / considerably / a great deal + comparative	Intensificación	Prices are considerably higher than last year.

ÍTEM MODELO

The new edition is much less comprehensive than the previous one.

NEAR

The new edition is _____ the previous one.

Respuesta: NOWHERE NEAR AS COMPREHENSIVE AS (5 palabras)

Qué se puntúa: nowhere near y la comparación de igualdad completa (as comprehensive as).

3.8 · Patrones verbales y verbos de reporte

Los verbos de reporte condensan en una frase lo que la frase 1 da en estilo directo. Lo que se evalúa es el patrón que sigue al verbo.

Patrón	Verbos	Ejemplo
verb + -ing	deny, admit, regret, recommend, suggest, resent	He denied having taken the money.
verb + preposition + -ing	insist on, object to, apologise for, confess to, resort to, succeed in	She insisted on paying for everyone.
verb + object + preposition + -ing	accuse sb of, blame sb for, congratulate sb on, prevent / deter sb from	They blamed the driver for causing the accident.

Patrón	Verbos	Ejemplo
verb + object + to + infinitive	urge, warn, advise, remind, persuade, forbid	Her lawyer urged her to reconsider.
verb + to + infinitive	threaten, refuse, offer, promise, claim	He threatened to resign.
verb + that + (should) + base form	suggest, insist, recommend, propose, demand	She suggested that we (should) postpone the trip.

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

Cuando to es preposición, va seguido de -ing: object to, be opposed to, resort to, confess to, look forward to, be committed to, with a view to. Y suggest nunca lleva objeto + infinitivo: *She suggested me to wait.

ÍTEM MODELO

'You took the money, didn't you, Mark?' said the manager.

ACCUSED

The manager _____ the money.

Respuesta: ACCUSED MARK OF TAKING (4 palabras). También: **ACCUSED MARK OF HAVING TAKEN** (5)

Qué se puntúa: el verbo con su objeto (accused Mark) y la preposición + -ing (of taking).

4 Nominalización

Es probablemente la transformación más característica del C2: la frase 1 usa un verbo o un adjetivo y la palabra clave obliga a expresar lo mismo con un sustantivo. Hay que dominar tres cosas: el sustantivo, el verbo que lo acompaña (la collocation) y la preposición que lo sigue, que a menudo no coincide con la del verbo.

Frase 1	Con sustantivo
decide (on)	come to / reach / make a decision (on / about)
conclude	come to / reach / draw the conclusion that
intend to	have no intention of -ing; with the intention of -ing
be sure / doubt	there is no doubt (that); beyond (all) doubt; cast doubt on
be similar to / resemble	bear a (close / striking) resemblance to
affect / influence	have an effect / impact / influence on
object to	raise an objection to; have no objection to -ing
explain	give / offer an explanation for
try (hard)	make an / every effort to
consider	take sth into consideration; give consideration to
be interested in	take / show an interest in
be important	be of (great) importance; attach importance to
complain	make a complaint about; have no complaints about
arrive / retire	on arrival; on one's retirement

Frase 1	Con sustantivo
respond to	in response to
because + clause	because of / owing to / on account of / in view of + noun
although + clause	despite / in spite of + noun or -ing; for all + noun

OJO · TRAMPA TÍPICA

La preposición cambia al nominalizar: affect sth → an effect on sth; decide sth → a decision on / about sth; resemble sb → a resemblance to sb. Y despite nunca lleva of.

ÍTEM MODELO

The committee has not yet decided whether to approve the plan.

DECISION

The committee has yet _____ whether to approve the plan.

Respuesta: TO REACH A DECISION ON (5 palabras). También: **TO COME TO A DECISION ABOUT** (6) · **TO MAKE A DECISION ON** (5)

Qué se puntúa: has yet to + verbo, que sustituye a has not yet, y la collocation con su preposición (reach a decision on).

ÍTEM MODELO

The two paintings are strikingly similar.

RESEMBLANCE

One painting _____ the other.

Respuesta: BEARS A STRIKING RESEMBLANCE TO (5 palabras)

Qué se puntúa: la collocation bear a resemblance y la preposición to. Sin striking se pierde la intensidad de strikingly.

5 Léxico: idioms y expresiones fijas

Si la palabra clave es un sustantivo inesperado (DARK, LOSS, STAKE, TERMS), casi seguro que pide una expresión fija. La frase 1 suele dar el equivalente llano, y el trabajo consiste en reconocerlo. Por eso las tablas van de lo fijo a lo llano: la columna derecha es lo que encontrarás en la frase 1.

5.1 · Verbos comodín + sustantivo

Los verbos de significado débil (take, give, come, make, bring, put, have) forman expresiones que no se traducen palabra por palabra. La clave puede ser el verbo o el sustantivo.

Expresión fija	Equivalente llano
take sth into account / consideration	consider sth
take sth for granted	assume sth; fail to appreciate sth
take exception to	be offended by
take issue with	disagree with
take its toll on	gradually damage

Expresión fija	Equivalente llano
give rise to	cause
give way to	be replaced by
give sb the benefit of the doubt	believe sb without proof
come to terms with	(learn to) accept
come to light	be discovered
come into effect / force	start to apply
come under fire / criticism	be criticised
make allowances for	be tolerant because of
make a point of -ing	do sth deliberately
make the most of	take full advantage of
bring sth home to sb	make sb fully realise sth
put sth down to	attribute sth to
have a say in	be involved in deciding
have no option / choice but to	be forced to
lose track of	no longer know where sth is or what is happening
keep pace with	progress at the same speed as
draw attention to	highlight
pay tribute to	praise publicly

ÍTEM MODELO

Sarah eventually accepted that her career as an athlete was over.

TERMS

Sarah eventually _____ the end of her career as an athlete.

Respuesta: CAME TO TERMS WITH (4 palabras)

Qué se puntúa: la expresión (came to terms) y su preposición (with); la nominalización (the end of) ya viene dada.

5.2 · Idioms frecuentes por palabra clave

Un idiom solo puntúa si está completo: artículo, preposición y orden incluidos.

Clave	Idiom en contexto	Equivale a
DARK	Staff were kept in the dark about the merger.	not told
LOSS	I was at a loss for words.	not know what to say
QUESTION	A refund is out of the question.	impossible; not allowed
POINT	Her age is beside the point.	irrelevant

Clave	Idiom en contexto	Equivale a
EAR	We haven't booked anything; we'll play it by ear.	decide as we go
MIND	It never crossed my mind that he might lie.	occur to
HEART	She had set her heart on studying medicine.	want very much
WORD	You'll have to take my word for it.	believe me
STAKE	Thousands of jobs are at stake.	at risk
HAND	The protest got out of hand.	out of control
LIGHT	He made light of his injuries.	treat as unimportant
LOOSE	I was at a loose end all weekend.	have nothing to do
ODDS	Against all the odds, they won.	although it was very unlikely
EDGE	Everyone was on edge before the results.	nervous
STRETCH	By no stretch of the imagination was it a success.	not at all
LEG	Without receipts, you don't have a leg to stand on.	have no valid argument
BREATH	Don't waste your breath arguing with him.	it's useless to
PAR	Her latest novel is on a par with her best work.	as good as
WAY	She went out of her way to help us.	make a special effort
REGARD	He is held in high regard by his colleagues.	greatly respected

ÍTEM MODELO

I had no idea what to say when she told me the news.

LOSS

I _____ when she told me the news.

Respuesta: WAS AT A LOSS FOR WORDS (6 palabras). También: **WAS AT A LOSS WHAT TO SAY** (7)

Qué se puntúa: el idiom completo (at a loss, con artículo) y su complemento (for words). Con was at a loss as to what to say serían 9 palabras: no vale.

5.3 · Phrasal verbs y prepositional verbs

La frase 1 suele traer un verbo de origen latino, y la clave es el verbo o la partícula del phrasal. Los de tres partes conservan todas sus partículas.

Frase 1	Phrasal	Frase 1	Phrasal
tolerate	put up with	postpone	put off
think of (an idea)	come up with	fail (a plan)	fall through
meet (expectations)	live up to	manage to see / hear	make out
resemble (a relative)	take after	reject	turn down
investigate	look into	find by chance	come across

Frase 1	Phrasal	Frase 1	Phrasal
recover from	get over	admire	look up to
despise	look down on	compensate for	make up for
use up	run out of	escape punishment for	get away with
disappoint	let down	deceive	take in
raise (a topic)	bring up	reduce	cut back on / cut down on
be persuaded to accept	come round to	explain explicitly	spell out

ÍTEM MODELO

The sequel didn't meet the critics' high expectations.

LIVE

The sequel failed _____ high expectations.

Respuesta: TO LIVE UP TO THE CRITICS' (6 palabras)

Qué se puntúa: el cambio didn't → failed to con el phrasal completo (to live up to) y el posesivo (the critics').

5.4 · Frases preposicionales

Sustituyen a conjunciones como because, if, although y suelen obligar a convertir la oración que sigue en un sustantivo o en un -ing.

Expresión	Equivale a
on the verge / brink / point of + -ing	about to
in the event of + noun / in the event that + clause	if there is / if
with a view to + -ing	with the aim of
regardless / irrespective of	without considering
on the grounds of + noun / on the grounds that + clause	because (as a justification)
in view of / in the light of	considering
in the wake of	following (sth bad)
at the expense of	causing loss or harm to
for the sake of	for the benefit of
by virtue of	because of (a quality)
in the absence of	without
in keeping with	consistent with
on the strength of	based on
to the best of my knowledge	as far as I know
at sb's disposal	available to sb

Expresión	Equivale a
under no obligation to	not obliged to

ÍTEM MODELO

Lucy took a part-time job because she wanted to save for a car.

VIEW

Lucy took a part-time job _____ for a car.

Respuesta: WITH A VIEW TO SAVING (5 palabras)

Qué se puntúa: la frase preposicional (with a view to) y el -ing obligatorio tras la preposición to (saving; *save cuesta esa mitad).

6 Trampas típicas

Casi todos los puntos que se pierden en esta parte salen de los mismos errores.

Trampa	Ejemplo	Cómo evitarla
Cambiar la palabra clave	DARK → *darkness; CLOSE → *closely	Cópiala tal cual: si cambia, el ítem vale 0.
Salirse de 3–8 palabras	*was at a loss as to what to say (9)	Cuenta al final; las contracciones valen dos.
Añadir información	*must have been kept in the dark (añade que alguien lo ocultó)	Nada de matices, adverbios ni agentes que no estén en la frase 1.
Perder información	strikingly similar → *bears a resemblance to	Repasa negación, tiempo, cantidad e intensidad.
Romper el tiempo verbal	It was believed that he had fled → *He is believed to have fled	El verbo principal conserva su tiempo.
No encajar con lo que sigue	*with a view to save; repetir una palabra que ya está tras el hueco	Lee la frase 2 completa con tu respuesta dentro.
Mezclar correlativos	*Hardly had we sat down than… / *No sooner had she left when…	hardly … when; no sooner … than.
Idiom alterado	*at loss; *out of question; *in the darkness	Artículos y preposiciones del idiom no son opcionales.
Ortografía	*accomodation; *occured; *embarassed	Una falta cuesta la mitad en la que está.
Hueco en blanco		Escribe siempre la mitad que sepas: vale 1 punto.

ESTRATEGIA DE EXAMEN

Tiempo: unos 12–15 minutos para la parte (2 por ítem). Primero los ítems en los que la clave dice algo al instante; los demás, al final.

Repaso de 20 segundos por ítem: clave intacta · 3–8 palabras · mismo tiempo y misma polaridad · nada añadido ni perdido · encaja con lo que sigue al hueco.

7 Tabla de referencia por palabra clave

Para repasar en enero: tapa la columna derecha e intenta recordar qué activa cada clave. Orden alfabético.

Clave	Suele activar
ACCOUNT	on account of; take sth into account; on no account (+ inversion); by all accounts
ALL	All (that) + subject + want is…; all but (= almost); for all (= despite); all in all
BEEN	had it not been for; must / can't have been; perfect passive (has been done)
BIT	every bit as … as; not a bit (= not at all); a bit of a + noun
BUT	but for + noun; all but; nothing but; cannot help but
CASE	in case of; in that case; in any case; it is (not) the case that
CHANCE	by chance; stand a chance of -ing; there's every chance that; the chances are (that); on the off chance
COME / CAME	come to terms with; come to light; come into effect; come as a surprise to; come up with; when it comes to
DOUBT	there's no doubt that; beyond doubt; cast doubt on; give sb the benefit of the doubt
DUE	due to; be due to + verb (= expected); in due course
EFFECT	have an effect on; come into / take effect; to the effect that; in effect
EFFORT	make an / every effort to; spare no effort
EVENT	in the event of / that; in any event
EXCEPTION	take exception to; with the exception of; make an exception
EXPENSE	at the expense of; at sb's expense; spare no expense
FAR	by far; as far as … is concerned; far from + -ing / adj. (= not at all); so far
HAD	Had + subject + past participle (conditional); hardly / no sooner had…; had better
HARDLY	hardly … when (+ inversion); hardly any / ever; hardly surprising
HAVE	perfect infinitive (to have done; must have done); have sth done; have no choice but to
IDEA	have no idea; not have the faintest / slightest idea
IF	if only; as if; even if; if anything; if it weren't / hadn't been for
INTENTION	have no intention of -ing; with the intention of -ing
IT	it is said that; it was not until … that; it's (high) time; it's no use -ing
LAST	the last thing + subject + verb; the last person to + verb; at (long) last
LEAST	not in the least; at the (very) least; least of all; to say the least
LIKELY / LIKELIHOOD	be (un)likely to; in all likelihood; the likelihood of -ing
LITTLE	Little did + subject + know; little or no; there is little point in -ing
LONG	as long as (= provided); no longer; before long; in the long run

Clave	Suele activar
LOSS	be at a loss (for words / to explain / what to do)
MATTER	no matter how / what; as a matter of course; a matter of time
MEANS	by no means (= not at all); by means of; a means of -ing
MIND	cross sb's mind; bear in mind; make up one's mind; in two minds; slip one's mind
NEAR	nowhere near as … as; in the near future
NO	no sooner; no matter; at no time; in no way; no point in -ing; no longer
NOT	not until (+ inversion); not only … but also; not so much … as
NOTICE	at short notice; take no notice of; come to sb's notice; until further notice
ODDS	against all (the) odds; at odds with; the odds are (that)
ONLY	only when / after / if / by + inversion; not only; the only thing; if only
POINT	no point in -ing; on the point of -ing; beside the point; make a point of -ing; up to a point
QUESTION	out of the question; beyond question; the … in question; call into question
RATHER	would rather + subject + past; rather than; or rather
REGARD	with regard to; hold sb in high regard; in this regard
SAKE	for the sake of; for sb's sake
SHORT	fall short of; run short of; at short notice; in short; cut short
SHOULD	Should + subject + verb (conditional); should have done; it's odd that + subject + should
SO	So + adj. + be … that (inversion); not so much … as; so as (not) to; or so
SOONER	no sooner … than; would sooner + subject + past; sooner or later
SUCH	Such + be + noun … that; such a + adj. + noun; as such
SUPPOSED	be supposed to (obligation, expectation, reputation)
TERMS	come to terms with; in terms of; on good terms with; in no uncertain terms
TIME	it's (high / about) time + subject + past; at no time (+ inversion); for the time being; in no time
TOUCH	be / keep in touch with; lose touch with; out of touch with
UNTIL	not until (+ inversion); it was not until … that; until further notice
VIEW	with a view to -ing; in view of; take a dim view of (= disapprove of)
WAY	there's no way (that); go out of one's way to; in the way; make way for; by way of
WERE	Were + subject + to + verb; were it not for; as it were
WHAT	What + subject + need is…; what with (= because of several things); what is more
WISH	wish + past / past perfect / would
WORTH	be (well) worth -ing; it's not worth -ing; for what it's worth; worth sb's while